



CSE472: HCI – Human Computer Interaction

Lecture – 1: The Beginning
Spring 2026



Inspiring Excellence

"Generate a picture to use for the introduction to my HCI class. Include scene where students in Bangladesh are learning together with AI in creating out of the world, innovative product designs." [ChatGPT]

Topics for Today

- Introductions and course structure
- Course overview
 - What will you learn?
 - How will I teach you?

Intro

- Farida Chowdhury
- MSc in Erasmus-Mundus Program: NeBCC (UK, Greece & Spain)
- PhD in P2P Networking in University of Stirling, Scotland, UK
- Research: HCI, Security Usability and Privacy, Gamification, Networking

Intro

- Say your name, and short background
- Any story about how you chose this class or interest in HCI
- Any other personal goals for the class

Course Administration



Course Teacher

Dr. Farida Chowdhury (FDC)
Professor, CSE, BRAC University
E-mail: farida.chowdhury@bracu.ac.bd



Lab teachers

Dr. Farida Chowdhury (FDC)
Ms. Marshia Nujhat
Ms. Umme Jannat Taposhi



Class Hours

Monday	: 2:00pm - 3:20pm @ 10B-16C
Wednesday	: 2:00pm - 3:20pm @ 10B-16C
Lab Hours	: 2:00pm - 5:00pm @ 12F-30L

Course Info and Communication

We will use discord (<https://discord.gg/Sz7WwJ8X>).

- Assigned readings
- *Lecture slides*
- *Assignment descriptions and deadlines*
- *Announcements*
- *...and many more!*

Lectures

- Most days, we will break up the class as follows:
- First ~10 mins: Short questions on the assigned reading
(to be turned in)
 - Next ~30 mins: Lecture
 - Last ~40 mins: Hands-on practice (to be turned in)

What will you Learn?

- You will learn and practice **fundamental HCI and Design** tools and techniques

Condensed and accelerated versions of core concepts

- We will focus on HCI **"practice"** – learn **practical** tools and techniques that you can use in your own projects/jobs
- You will get **hands-on practice** applying and using those tools and techniques – both in-class and through assignments
- You will learn what you **need to know** to be able **to do, understand, and communicate** about HCI and Design in the real world (as a software engineer, UX researcher, entrepreneur, etc.)

What will you Learn?

- You will NOT learn to be a great designer in ~14 weeks.
.... that would take years of practice and dedication!



What will you Learn?

- I just want you to tell me how to make my <insert project/app/product> pretty and perfect!
- Good design is a process that requires time and effort.
- You have to learn the process and follow it every time you need to design (or re-design) something!
- I will teach you the process and give you opportunities to practice following the process.
- HCI teaches you **how to think and work like a designer**, not just how to make things look good

How will you Learn?

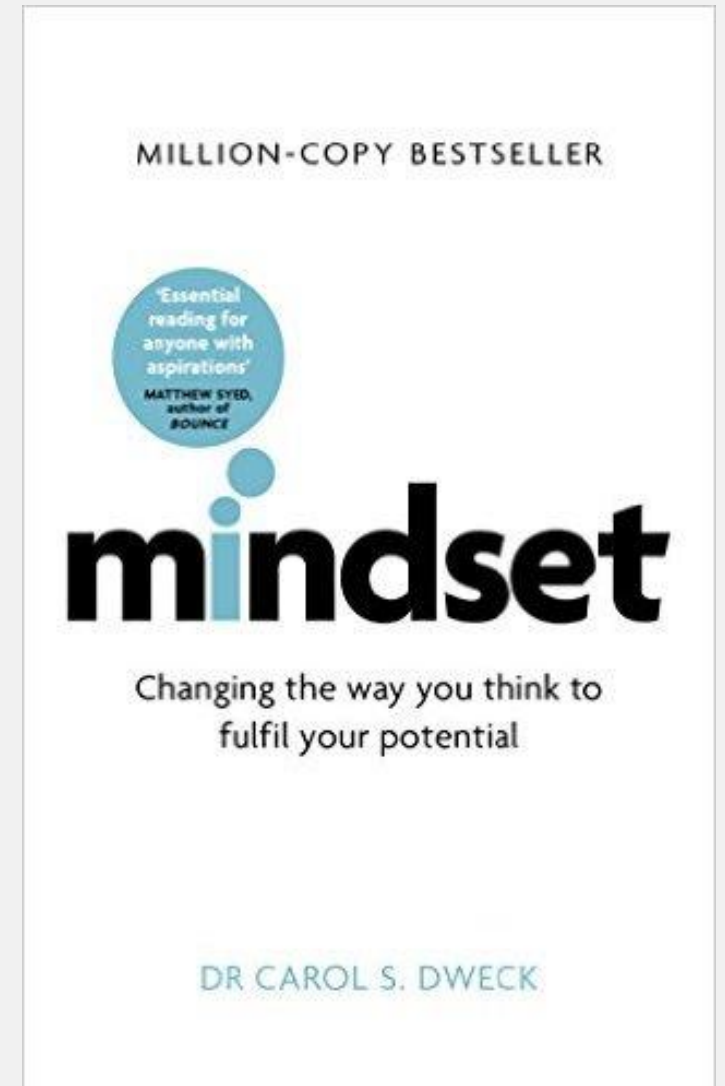
But I'm really bad at design...

But I can't draw...

But I don't know how to code...

But I only know how to code....

- In this class (and in your life) I want you to consciously try to have a **Growth Mindset** (Carol Dweck)



"Failure is an
opportunity to grow"

GROWTH MINDSET

"I can learn to do anything I want"

"Challenges help me to grow"

"My effort and attitude
determine my abilities"

"Feedback is constructive"

"I am inspired by the success of others"

"I like to try
new things"

"Failure is the
limit of my abilities"

FIXED MINDSET

"I'm either good at it or I'm not"

"My abilities are unchanging"

"I don't like
to be challenged"

"I can either do it,
or I can't"

"My potential is predetermined"

"When I'm frustrated,
I give up"

"Feedback and criticism
are personal"

"I stick to what I know"

FIXED MINDSET

- SOMETHING YOU'RE BORN WITH
- FIXED

- SOMETHING TO AVOID
- COULD REVEAL LACK OF SKILL
- TEND TO GIVE UP EASILY

- UNNECESSARY
- SOMETHING YOU DO WHEN YOU ARE NOT GOOD ENOUGH

- GET DEFENSIVE
- TAKE IT PERSONAL

- BLAME OTHERS
- GET DISCOURAGED

SKILLS

CHALLENGES

EFFORT

FEEDBACK

SETBACKS

GROWTH MINDSET

- COME FROM HARD WORK.
- CAN ALWAYS IMPROVE

- SHOULD BE EMBRACED
- AN OPPORTUNITY TO GROW.
- MORE PERSISTANT

- ESSENTIAL
- A PATH TO MASTERY

- USEFUL
- SOMETHING TO LEARN FROM
- IDENTIFY AREAS TO IMPROVE

- USE AS A WAKE-UP CALL TO WORK HARDER NEXT TIME.

How to succeed in this class?

- It's all about effort. I will reward effort.
 - Ultimately, the effort you put into the class determines what you get out of the class.
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1. Keep a growth mindset
 2. Make an effort to do the assigned reading
 3. Make an effort to show up to class on time and pay attention
 4. Make an effort to engage in the in-class activities
 5. Make an effort to work hard on the assignments

Course Outline

Weeks	Topics
Week - 1	Introduction to Human Computer Interaction (HCI)
Week - 2	Design of Everyday Things
Week - 3	Quantitative Study: Survey Design
Week - 4	Qualitative Study: Interviews and Focus Groups, Contextual Enquiry
Week - 5	Analysing Qualitative Data
Week - 6	Personas, User Stories, Storyboarding
Week - 7	Paper Prototyping, High-fidelity Prototyping, Digital Prototyping
Week - 8	Web Accessibility
Week - 9	Designing for Marginalized Communities
Week - 10	Usability, Heuristic Evaluation
Week - 11	Discuss some of others' research and wrap up

Books

- The Design of Everyday Things - Donald A. Norman
- Interaction Design: Beyond Human-Computer Interaction - Sharp, Rogers, and Preece
- Designing the User Interface - Ben Shneiderman and Catherine Plaisant
- Supplementary readings from journals and conferences (e.g., CHI, UIST, CSCW, SOUPS, MobileHCI)

Marks distribution (tentative)

- Lab activities : 25%
- Reading Quiz : 5%
- Paper Presentation : 5%
- Assignments &
class activities : 10%
- Mid : 10%
- Final : 15%
- Project : 30%

Acknowledgment

- Will follow contents from Cornell University Course “HCI and Design”
- Took permission from Professor Nicki Dell (nixdell.com)

Any questions?